

FIRST FILIPINO ANTONIN CAREME AWARDEE – The Cravings Group founder and president Annie Pascual Guerrero (center), Antonin Careme awardee, poses after the awarding (with (from left) her son Audie Guerrero; Anne Palmares, corporate PR Manager of CCA, Manila; Michael Ty, AAC American Culinary Federation (ACF) Immediate Past President and Foundation Chairman; Jay Marshall, CEC, AAC, President of the American Culinary Federation (ACF) San Francisco Chapter; Judith Imperial, executive director of The Cravings Group and Virgilio Heredia.

Susana P. Guerrero, first Filipino given Antonin Careme distinction

In recognition of her visionary leadership, commitment and continuing legacy to create significant impacts on the society through world-class culinary education and ethical business practices, The Cravings Group (TCG) Founder and President Susana "Annie" Pascual-Guerrero was recently honored with a medal by the prestigious Antonin Careme Society.

The first Filipino to be given this distinction, Guerrero was formally recognized as a member of the Antonin Careme Society Class of 2015 at Cliff House San Francisco in California, last November 16.

Apart from propagating the passion for cooking and elevating it into a noble profession through the establishment of the country's pioneer culinary arts school, the Center for Culinary, Arts (CCA, Manila), Guerrero was cited for her many meaningful contributions not only in culinary education but in many groundbreaking advocacies on entrepreneurship, sustainable environmentalism, and corporate social responsibility on various levels.

The Antonin Careme Medal was first awarded in 1969. Since then, it has honored chefs from all over the world who have made extraordinary contributions to the upliftment of the culinary profession. The honor was named after French chef Antonin Careme, the "Chef of Kings" and "King of Chefs." Past recipients of this prestigious honor include Julia Child, Narsai David, Martin Yan, Bradley Ogden, among others.

Filipino receives 'King of Chefs' medal

A FILIPINO has joined the ranks of the world's top chefs when she was cited by the prestigious Antonin Carême Society, which is named after the Frenchman dubbed the "Chef of Kings" and "King of Chefs" and who served Europe's royalty in the 18th century.

Susana "Annie" Pascual-Guerrero, founder and president of The Cravings Group, was awarded the Antonin Carême Medal and was formally recognized as a member of the Antonin Carême Society Class of 2015 at Cliff House San Francisco in California on Nov. 16.

The Antonin Carême Medal was first awarded in 1969 to honor chefs from all over the world who made extraordinary contributions to the culinary profession. Recipients have included Julia Child, Narsai David, Martin Yan, Bradley Ogden, Andrew Sutton and Nunzio Alioto.

Guerrero, who put up the pioneering Center for Culinary Arts in the Philippines, was cited for her contributions to culinary education as well as her advocacies—entrepreneurship, sustainable environmentalism and corporate social responsibility.

In her speech, Guerrero dedicated the honor to the overseas Filipino workers in the hospitality industry whose talents and skills, she said, were at par with the finest in the world.

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Guerrero 1st Filipina to receive Antonin Careme distinction

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Photo shows Annie Pascual Guerrero (center), with (from left) her son Audie Guerrero; Anne Palmares, corporate PR manager, CCA, Manila; Michael Ty, AAC American Culinary Federation immediate past president and foundation chairman; Jay Marshall, CEC, AAC, president, American Culinary Federation San Francisco Chapter; Judith Imperial, executive director, The Cravings Group and Virgilio Heredia.

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Cravings head honored. The Cravings Group founder and president Susana Pascual-Guerrero (center) is honored with a medal by the prestigious Antonin Careme Society in recognition of her visionary leadership and legacy to create significant impacts on the society through world-class culinary education and ethical business practices. The first Filipino to be given this distinction, Guerrero is formally recognized as a member of the Antonin Careme Society Class of 2015 at Cliff House San Francisco in California on November 16, 2015. She was also recognized as the first certified culinary professional in the Philippines by the International Association of Culinary Professionals.

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Hospitality
News Philippines

The industry guide to management and career

CSR ISSUE



Kitchen SCHOLARS

Since 2001, Culinary Education Foundation, Inc.'s scholarship programs have improved more than 1,000 lives

CONCIERGE: Still relevant?

Catering the PAPAL VISIT

Masterlist of NEW HOTELS in 2015





Susana "Annie" Pascual-Guerrero

MAKING AN IMPACT

Experts suggest that companies must integrate CSR into their goals to build long-term and effective programs. But even those that do still face challenges like sustaining the project. The Cravings Group shares its story

Many lives have been changed by food, and the seven people in the room understand this best.

Hospitality News is with seven scholars of The Cravings Group, a restaurant, hotel, and school operator that built its own nonprofit arm called Culinary Education Foundation, Inc. (CEF) in 2001. One of them, Bryner Telmo, 28 years old, now manages a concessionaire in a government center. Like Telmo, his colleague Matt Julius Lerin, 23, applied for scholarship to continue his education after discontinuing college due to financial reasons. Patrick Silver Padao, 24, is deaf and dreams of building a culinary school for people with hearing impairments.

Stephanie Claire Montalvo, 24, and Manuel de Leon Jr., 34, are shifting careers. Meanwhile, through her education and employment at the company's catering division, May Ann Gallo, 32, found it easier to fully supporting her two children. The 51-year old Luzviminda Castillo says it is not too late to learn new skills.

For over 14 years, more than a thousand scholars including persons with disabilities and women went through CEF's education programs. Formal culinary education became the ticket to jumpstart their careers in the kitchen, and many of CEF's graduates now work for hotels and restaurants in the provinces or the company's restaurant outlets.

That track record makes CEF one of the most successful CSR entities in the industry, and it is proof that CSR programs, when designed for the long term, can significantly improve communities.

And yet not all companies view CSR with such dedication. Many are still stuck in the notion that R in the abbreviation means Reputation more than Responsibility.

A 2006 *Harvard Business Review* article about CSR observed that despite social pressure on companies to engage in social good projects, CSR remained disconnected from business goals. Companies regarded CSR as compliance and a fulfillment of moral obligation, resulting to programs that look like feel-good marketing campaigns.

That track record makes CEF one of the most successful CSR entities in the industry, and it is proof that CSR programs, when designed for the long term, can significantly improve communities.

These days, several players in the industry have done the reverse. They acknowledge that CSR is beyond PR—it is practical for business. Business wins when society wins, argues the CSR department of an integrated resort in Metro Manila.

Susana Pascual-Guerrero, president of The Cravings Group and head of CEF, is a staunch advocate of education ever since opening CCA in 1996. In an interview, Marinela Guerrero-Trinidad, CEO of the company, said that pushing for culinary education in the Philippines ultimately helps the industry and even their restaurant business.

And so it made sense to introduce a foundation that will extend the advocacy to aspiring chefs who cannot afford their tuition fee. Over the past years, CEF has concentrated in Metro Manila, Bulacan, and Ilocos Sur; and many of the graduates now work in different locations as far as Macau. While scholars are not mandated to work for the group after graduation, many do so by choice.

CEF is not only for education, though. It has turned towards a more difficult social problem that also affects the group's business—the environment.

Food and restaurant operations are known contributors of greenhouse gases. For instance, a half-pound hamburger can release as much greenhouse gas as a 3,000-pound car driving in 10 miles, according to the *Scientific American* magazine. That is due to the pollution caused by raising livestock.

"Sustainability is the balance between people and environment. Certainly, our organizations' operation is directly affected by how

PHOTOS BY STANLEY ONG

employees comply and utilize vital life resources: land, air and water," reasons Guerrero.

Among the pro-environment programs CEF launched were "green chefmanship" courses for CCA and CEF students and books such as *A-Z Guide for a Green Chef* published by CEF with Moist Communicates and Moist Publishing. The Cravings Group has successfully applied in 2013 and renewed in 2014 an ISO 14001, which certified its environmental management system.

Last year, CEF collaborated with Farm to Table Connections to implement a nationwide program of spreading bokashi technology (a food waste composting method) for livelihood and organic farming. Bokashi has been introduced to communities around the Philippines including Tacloban, Leyte.

CEF has also developed an organic farm in Antipolo. Called ANI, Guerrero envisions the farm to grow organic plants and livestock, produce fertilizers, harvest solar energy, and conduct culinary and livelihood training. A larger farm is underway in Bukidnon.

Sustaining sustainability

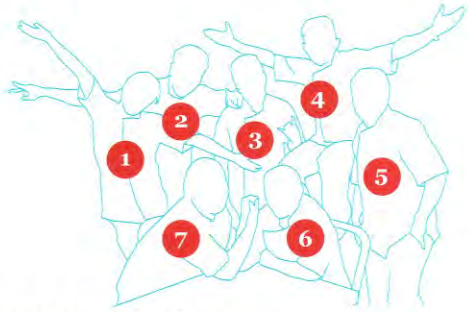
The foundation has been supported by international aid agencies and organizations like the World Bank, U.S. Department of Agriculture, and Canadian International Development Agency and local groups for funding. During the fundraiser 2014 Manila Food and Wine Festival, CEF gathered enough donations to fund the scholarship of more than 200 students this year.

But unlike social projects like scholarship and livelihood training, environmental programs are harder to sustain, admits Guerrero. She cited a project that involved developing 3,000 square meters of empty land into an organic garden. After a year of CEF's tending to the project, the land was rented out by the owner to a real estate developer.

If Guerrero has learned anything about sustaining any CSR project, that is to start small. And true enough, many of her projects have paid off even in simple forms.

Telmo, the scholar who built himself a concessionaire business, said he has been implementing green chefmanship lessons in the catering business. "I avoid food waste. We still make use of the things considered trash in the kitchen," says Telmo. For instance, he uses potato peals as chips for appetizers, which adds value to combo meals without incurring any significant marginal cost.

Guerrero has observed an increasing number of local companies engaging in CSR, especially environmental projects. But she still notes that companies can do much more to create bigger impacts on society and change more lives for the better. The seeds planted on CEF scholars would likely bring out the big results she dreams of in the near future. HNP



CEF scholars

1 Stephanie Claire Montalvo
A CEF scholar, she helps the foundation as a sign language interpreter.

2 Matt Julius Lerin
He stopped college because of financial reasons. Before CEF, he worked in real estate and modeling.

3 Manuel de Leon Jr.
After working for a fast food company, he hopes the chance of learning cooking from the basics will lead him to become a chef one day.

4 Patrick Silver Padao
Amid his hearing impairment, he has his own homemade cake business. In the future, he wants to build a school for the deaf interested in cooking.

5 Bryner Telmo
Unable to finish college, he worked as a family driver before entering CEF. He now has a concessionaire business in Malabon.

6 Luzviminda Castillo
At 51 years old, she is still eager to learn and is now assigned to look after CEF's mobile kitchen.

7 May Ann Gallo
She went through various livelihood training under CEF, and eventually hired by The Cravings Group to work at various outlets. She is now involved in catering and manages a small food stall at home.

CSR IN THE INDUSTRY

Resorts World Manila

Structure: CSR programs are divided into three themes: Philippine tourism and arts, environment, and society. The company said it has aligned CSR with its vision and mission.

Leadership: CSR team is under the corporate communications department.

Goals: CSR to "make communities win and are a direct reflection of our unwavering commitment towards corporate citizenship. Leveraging on our strengths—a pioneering tourism company, our focus on the performing arts, a growing and dynamic workforce, a broad membership base, and an extensive network of partners—we link our business to relevant social issues through innovative approaches that allow both our community and the environment to win."

Achievements:

- LEAP, a training and employment program for the less privileged members of Pasay. Beneficiaries are given job training in RWM and some have been hired.
- 1,700 people received medical aid in Eastern Samar, while 300 volunteers trained on first aid and basic life support
- 425,710 cc of blood donated by 643 employees
- PHP43,480 donation via the Win-Win program. Points gathered by RWM members were converted to cash to provide a steady supply of rice to city street children
- Two 4-storey school buildings (48 classrooms) sponsored in Pasay and Parañaque
- 8,000 underprivileged persons saw free RWM stage productions to bring world-class theater closer to more people

Challenges in implementation: Employee engagement



One of RWM's CSR projects for schools. Photo courtesy of RWM.

Mövenpick Hotel Mactan Island Cebu

Structure: Tapped Gawad Kalinga for post-disaster housing. Manny O. Group's nonprofit arm, HopeNow Philippines, has a separate project on medical relief for disaster-hit sites. Manny O. Group owns Mövenpick Hotel Mactan Island.

Leadership: HopeNow Philippines. Manny Osmeña has been hands-on with the project.

Goals: Through HopeNow Philippines, the goal of Hospital on Wheels project is to deploy a fully functioning mobile medical facility in the disaster zone within 24-48 hours following the disaster. Through Gawad Kalinga, the goal is to build 160 houses in disaster-hit areas in Leyte, Cebu, Bohol, and Samar.





Gawad Kalinga houses (top). One of the wine bottles auctioned by Manny Osmeña (bottom). Photo courtesy of Manny O. Group

Progress and achievements:

- 40 houses completed and turned over to fisherfolk families in Madridejos, Cebu
- 120 houses being constructed in Sagbayan, Bohol; Hernani, Samar; and Alang-alang, Leyte. Project completion due in March 2015.
- PHP8.4 million worth of wines sold in an auction for HopeNow's project on medical relief

Culinary scholars share stories of hope, positive transformation

For young learners from low-income families, meeting the ever-increasing costs of a college or vocational education is a constant struggle. Thanks to the support of corporate sponsors and the Culinary Education Foundation (CEF), the advocacy arm of The Cravings Group, access to quality free education is attainable for those who aspire for bigger dreams for themselves and their families.

This reality best demonstrates the inspirational stories of Catherine Mendoza, Edureal Ledda, Dinayen Monterero, and Jonathan Domasig, as they overcame the challenges of poverty through the CEF scholarship grants. Together with their fellow CEF recipients, they are expected to see their efforts rewarded come graduation this December.



Dinayen Monterero

The four are among the chosen 200 scholars who benefited from CEF's Manila Food and Wine Festival Charity Gala Night last October 2014. They were chosen to represent the first batch of Doña Elena Brand Scholars of Fly Ace Corp., through the leadership of its EVP for Sales and Marketing, Larry Cochanco. The Doña Elena brand was among the major sponsors that committed financial support that helped in successfully raising substantial academic stipend for the Batch 8 and incoming Batch 9 of CEF scholars.

To date, more than a hundred individuals, including out-of-school youth, mothers and members of indigent communities, have successfully finished and benefited from the free culinary education, career and livelihood programs of CEF.

Creating a purposeful future

Ledda and Domasig say that the grant equipped them to pursue promising career possibilities. Ledda cites Green Chefmanship, zero-waste management practices and positive attitude development as among his important lessons at CEF. "I feel so blessed to be given the opportunity to continue my education. Through this, I aim to achieve my dream of becoming a culinary professional, harness my skills, as well as impart my learnings to others in our community," says Ledda.

"I am extremely proud to be a CEF scholar. With CEF's guidance and trust, my batchmates and I are given new hope. I also thank Fly Ace Corp. for their support and Mr. Cochanco for referring us to the foundation. No words are enough to express my appreciation and gratitude," says the 29-year-old Monterero.

For Mendoza, a full-time helper and nanny, striving for a better future was made possible with the support of her employer, Jen Gumata of Fly Ace Corp., who let her focus on her classes during weekends. "I am very fortunate to have an understanding and supportive employer. Her encouragement really meant a lot in keeping me inspired in my studies. Together with my batchmates, we are looking towards better opportunities in life," says Mendoza.

Philanthropy lives on

Cochanco says he is happy and proud of the scholars' achievements. "In behalf of our Doña Elena brand and employees of Fly Ace Corp., we are delighted by this outcome. We are honored to extend the company's vision to provide academic opportunities to CEF scholars. This is an outstanding example, and it will inspire us more to fulfill our philanthropic duties to the Filipino community," he says.

"Corporate social volunteerism is vital in creating a bright future for the scholars and for the economic progress of the country," shares Susana P. Guerrero, founder and president of CEF.

For more information, visit www.cefmanila.com.

Graduating CEF scholars share stories of hope, transformation

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The four are among the chosen 200 scholars that benefited from the Manila Food and Wine Festival (MFWF) Charity Gala Night of CEF in October 2014. These four scholars were chosen to represent the first batch of Doña Elena Brand Scholars of Fly Ace Corp., through the leadership of its Executive Vice President for Sales and Marketing Larry Cochanco. Doña Elena brand was among the major sponsors that committed financial support that helped successfully raise substantial academic stipend for the Batch 8 and incoming Batch 9 of CEF scholars.

To date, more than a hundred individuals—out-of-school youth, mothers and members of indigent communities—have successfully finished and benefited from the free culinary education, career and livelihood programs of CEF.

Creating a purposeful future

THE story of the scholars started no differently from those coming from poor families. Just a few years ago, they are among those who couldn't imagine attaining higher vocational learning—let alone quality culinary education—as they struggle to provide for their families.

But by virtue of the CEF scholarship, they were given the opportunity to transform their lives and those that they love. They received holistic educational and core competency training support to ensure their successful transition into the food industry.

Ledda and Domasig said the grant made them better equipped to pursue a promising career in the future. Ledda cited Green Chefmanship, zero-waste management practices and positive attitude development as among his important learnings at CEF.

"I feel so blessed to be given the opportunity to continue my education. Through this, I aim to achieve my dream of becoming a culinary professional and harness my skills, as well as impart my learnings to others in our community," Ledda said.

"I am extremely proud to be a CEF scholar. With its guidance and trust, my batchmates and I are given new hope. I also thank Fly Ace Corp. for its support and Mr. Cochanco for referring us to the foundation. No words are enough to express my appreciation and gratitude," the 29-year-old Monterero said. She used to work in a *carinderia*, while Ledda was a baker in a *pan de sal* store.

For Mendoza, a full-time helper and nanny, striving for a better future is made possible with the support of her employer, Jen Gumata of Fly Ace Corp., who let her focus on her classes during weekends.

"I am very fortunate to have an understanding and supportive employer. Her encouragement really meant a lot in keeping me inspired in my studies. Together with my batchmates, we are looking toward better opportunities in life," she said.

Philantrophy lives on

FOR his part, Cochanco said he is very happy and proud of the scholars' achievement. "In behalf of our Doña Elena brand and employees of Fly Ace Corp., we are delighted with this outcome. We are honored to extend the company's vision to provide academic opportunities to CEF scholars. This is an outstanding example, and it will inspire us more to fulfill our philanthropic duties to the Filipino community."

"Corporate social volunteerism is vital in creating a bright future for the scholars and for the economic progress of the country. Together with Doña Elena brand of Fly Ace Corp., we will continue to coordinate advocacy efforts to support and provide scholarship opportunities to deserving students from poor communities," said Susana "Annie" P. Guerrero, founder and president of CEF.

Dedicated to help promising individuals from low-income communities overcome the barriers by providing them mentorship, industry-grade standards, training, tools and equal learning opportunities, CEF's mission to help create meaningful difference in the lives of many aspiring students and their families will live on.

Scholars see brighter future, positive transformation

YOUNG learners from low-income families have found that access to quality free education was possible through the support of corporate sponsors and the Culinary Education Foundation (CEF), advocacy arm of The Cravings Group.

Catherine Mendoza, Edureal Ledda, Dinayen Monterero and Jonathan Domasig were able to overcome the challenges of poverty through CEF scholarship grants.

The four, who will graduate in December, were among the 200 beneficiaries of CEF's Manila Food and Wine Festival Charity Gala Night in October.

They were part of the first batch of scholars of the Doña Elena brand of Fly Ace Corp., through the leadership of executive vice president for sales and marketing Larry Cochanco. Doña Elena's financial support helped provide stipends for CEF's batches 8 and 9 scholars.

More than a hundred out-of-school youth, mothers and members of indigent communities availed of CEF's free culinary education program.

Ledda and Domasig said the grant made them better equipped to pursue their chosen careers. Ledda, who was a baker in a pan de sal store, cited in particular Green Chefmanship, zero-waste management practices and positive attitude development among the important lessons he learned.

Monterero, 29, who used to work in a *karinderia*, said she and her batchmates were given new hope through the program. She thanked Fly Ace for its support and Cochanco for referring them to CEF.



DOMASIG, Monterero, Mendoza and Ledda are flanked by Fly Ace's senior product manager Zen Prudentino and associate marketing and PR manager MJ Cordova.

Mendoza, a full-time helper and nanny, said a better future was made possible for her with the support of her employer, Jen Gumata of Fly Ace, who let her focus on her classes on weekends.

Cochanco said he was very happy and proud of the scholars' achievements. The Doña Elena brand and Fly Ace, he said, were honored to extend the company's vision to provide academic opportunities to CEF scholars. He said what their grantees had accomplished would inspire them "to fulfill our philanthropic duties to the Filipino community."

Susana "Annie" P. Guerrero, CEF founder and president, said corporate social volunteerism was vital in creating a bright future for the scholars and for the economic progress of the country. With Doña Elena brand of Fly Ace, she said they would continue efforts to support and provide scholarships to deserving students from poor communities.

Visit www.cefmanila.com.

THE PHILIPPINE STAR

The GOOD NEWS

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Editor: TAMMY MENDOZA

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CEF scholars share stories of hope, positive transformation

For students coming from low-income families, the cost of a college or vocational education can be quite daunting. But thanks to the support of corporate sponsors and the Culinary Education Foundation (CEF), the advocacy arm of The Cravings Group, quality free education has become within reach for those aspiring for bigger dreams for themselves and their families.

Such is the case of scholars Catherine Mendoza, Edureal Ledda, Dinayen Monterero and Jonathan Domasig, who hope to overcome their poverty with the help of CEF scholarship grants. Together with fellow recipients, they are expected to graduate in December and to fulfill their dreams.

The four are among the chosen 200 scholars to benefit from the Manila Food and Wine Festival (MFWF) Charity Gala Night of CEF last October 2014. They were chosen to represent the first batch of Doña Elena brand scholars of Fly Ace Corp., represented by its EVP for sales and marketing Larry Cochanco. Doña Elena was among the major sponsors that committed financial support for the academic stipend of the incoming batch of CEF scholars.

To date, more than a hundred individuals – out-of-school youth, mothers, and members of indigent communities – have successfully finished and benefited from the free culinary education, career and livelihood programs of the culinary foundation.



With the help of Culinary Education Foundation, Fly Ace and quality culinary education, Dinayen Monterero, who used to work in a *carinderia*, now has a shot at a better future.

A BETTER FUTURE

The story of the scholars started no differently from many others who come from poor families. Just a few years ago, education was beyond their reach. Attaining higher vocational learning – let alone quality culinary education – was farthest from their priorities as they struggled to provide for their families from day to day.

But by virtue of the CEF scholarship, they were given an opportunity to transform their lives. They received holistic educational and core competency training support to ensure their successful entry into the competitive food industry.

Ledda and Domasig said the grant made them better equipped to pursue a promising career in the future. Ledda cited Green Chefmanship, zero-waste management practices and positive attitude development among his important learnings at CEF.

"I feel so blessed to be given the opportunity to continue my education. Through this, I aim to achieve my dream of becoming a culinary professional, and harness my skills as well as impart my learnings to others in our community," Ledda said.

"I am extremely proud to be a CEF scholar. With their guidance and trust, my batchmates and I are given new hope. I also thank Fly Ace Corp. for their support and Mr. Cochanco for referring us to the foundation. No words are enough to express my appreciation and gratitude," said the 29-year-old Monterero. She used to work in a carinderia, while Ledda was a baker in a pan de sal store.

For Mendoza, a full-time helper and nanny, striving for a better future is made possible with the support of her employer, Jen Gumata, who allowed her to focus on her classes during weekends.

"I am very fortunate to have an understanding and supportive employer. Her encouragement really meant a lot in keeping me inspired in my studies. Together with my batchmates, we are looking toward better opportunities in life," she said.

PHILANTHROPY LIVES ON

For his part, Cochanco said he is happy and proud of the scholars' achievements. "In behalf of our Doña Elena brand and employees of Fly Ace Corp., we are delighted with this outcome. We are honored to extend the company's vision to provide academic opportunities to CEF scholars. This is an outstanding example, and it will inspire us more to fulfill our philanthropic duties to the Filipino community."

"Corporate social volunteerism is vital in creating a bright future for the scholars and for the economic progress of the country. Together with Doña Elena brand of Fly Ace Corp., we will continue to coordinate advocacy efforts to support and provide scholarship opportunities to deserving students from poor communities," said Susana Guerrero, founder and president of CEF.

Dedicated to help promising individuals from low-income communities overcome their circumstances by providing them mentorship, industry-grade standards, training, tools and equal learning opportunities, CEF's mission to help create meaningful difference in the lives of many aspiring students and their families will continue to live on.

For more information, visit *www.cefmanila.com*.

THE WONDERS OF BOKASHI

(or how composting brings progress to communities)



Susana Guerrero demonstrates to Senator Loren Legarda how bokashi is made

You hear the word "bokashi" and you'd think of it as Japanese. Or if you were a twenty-something who is familiar with Beki-speak, it would mean a request to open the door or something. Bokashi, to the uninformed, refers to the technology of composting that is low-cost, mess-free, pest-free and odor-free.

This technology, which was launched by The Cravings Group's corporate social responsibility arm The Culinary Foundation Inc. on Earth Day last year, is now being embraced by at least 40 communities all over the country.

During the first National Integrated Waste Management Exhibition organized by the Department of Environment and Natural Resources' National Solid Waste Management Commission headed by director Eli Ildefonso, The Cravings Group/CEF showcased its commitment by participating in the five-day event through a series of seminars and demos that engaged visitors and audiences, mostly environmentalist groups and students.

The event also served as an occasion for the awarding of a P50,000 prize to the "Most Sustainable Bokashi Program" – which went to Barangay Magay in Tanauan, Leyte. CEF envisions the Bokashi technology to immensely contribute to the growing demand for organic farming which is crucial to health and food security in the Philippines. TCG's Susana P. Guerrero, concurrently the president of Zero Waste Philippines, Inc., was at the forefront in this landmark event. Senator Loren Legarda, who was also present, lauded TCG in her speech at the Green Summit sponsored by the World Bank's International Finance Corporation after watching the actual demo in the exhibit.

The event also gave CEF the opportunity to introduce to the public their one-day seminar on "Best Green Practices in Commercial Kitchens" to promote Green Chefmanship and Going Zero Waste in the hospitality industry. Another highlight of the event was the TCG's opportunity to show how it was able to steer the company into an ISO 14001 Certification, the global standard in environmental excellence.

For more information on CEF's seminars and activities, call Mel Adriano of CEF (4/F, CCA Bldg, 287 Katipunan Avenue, QC), with nos. (02) 426-1338, 925-3969; e-mail: admin@cefmanila.com or follow them on Facebook.

Culinary group highlights wonders of bokashi composting technology



SUSANA P. GUERRERO (left) of The Cravings Group hands over the P50,000 prize to the Most Sustainable Bokashi Program winner, Barangay Magay, Tanauan, Leyte, represented by Fr. Rich Gomez, MSC, and Sis. Zaida Villareal, OSB.

TRUE to its calling as a responsible corporate entity, The Cravings Group (TCG), the country's most dynamic chain with diversified interests in the restaurant business, culinary and hospitality schools and food and beverage service, renews its commitment to environmental causes with its participation in the first National Integrated Waste Management Exhibition, through its corporate social-responsibility arm, the Culinary Education Foundation (CEF) Inc.

TCG's Susana P. Guerrero, concurrently the president of Zero Waste Philippines Inc., was in the forefront in this landmark event. It was initiated and organized by the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR)–National Solid-Waste Management Commission headed by Director Eli Ildefonso.

As a Platinum Partner exhibitor, TCG maximized its participation in the five-day exhibit through a series of seminars and demos that engaged visitors and audiences, mostly environmentalist groups and students.

What attracted most in the presentation was the bokashi technology of composting that is low-cost, mess-free, pest-free and odor-free. Easily replicable, it is now being embraced by at least 40 communities all over the country since it was launched by the CEF on Earth Day last year.

The event was also an occasion to award the P50,000 prize to the Most Sustainable Bokashi Program that was given to Barangay Magay, Tanauan, Leyte. The barangay was represented by Father Rich Gomez, MSC, and the facsimile check was handed to Sister Zaida Villareal, OSB, by Guerrero.

CEF envisions the Bokashi technology to immensely contribute to the growing demand for organic farming, which is crucial to health and food security in the Philippines.

Sen. Loren B. Legarda commended TCG for its endeavor. She mentioned it in her speech at the Green Summit sponsored by World Bank's IFC, after watching the actual demo in the exhibit. The event also gave CEF the opportunity to open to the public its one-day seminar on Best Green Practices in Commercial Kitchens. This aims to promote Green Chefmanship and Going Zero Waste in the hospitality industry. Another highlight of the event was the TCG's opportunity to show how they were able to steer the company into an ISO 14001 Certification, the global standard in environmental excellence.

For more information on CEF's seminars and activities, it may be contacted through e-mail *admin@cefmanila.com* or Facebook.

PHILIPPINE DAILY INQUIRER
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Cravings Group CSR unit highlights benefits of bokashi

THE CRAVINGS Group (TCG), which has interests in restaurants, culinary and hospitality schools and F&B service, has renewed its commitment to environmental causes with its participation in the first National Integrated Waste Management Exhibition, through its CSR arm —the Culinary Education Foundation (CEF), Inc.

TCG's Susana P. Guerrero, also the president of Zero Waste Philippines, Inc. (ZWPI), was at the forefront of this landmark event.

It was initiated and organized by the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR)—National Solid Waste Management Commission (NSWMC) headed by director Eli Ildefonso.

As a Platinum Partner exhibitor, TCG maximized its participation in the five-day exhibit through a series of seminars and demos that engaged visitors and audiences, mostly environmentalist groups and students.

A highlight was the Bokashi technology of composting that is low-cost, mess-free, pest-free and odor-free.

Easy replicable, it has been embraced by at least 40 communities in the country since it was launched on Earth Day last year.

The event was also an occasion to award the P50,000 prize to the 'Most Sustainable Bokashi Program' that was given to Barangay Magay, Tanauan, Leyte.

The barangay was represented by Fr. Rich Gomez MSC and the facsimile check handed to Sr. Zaida Villareal OSB by Guerrero.

CEF envisions the Bokashi technology to contribute greatly to the growing demand for organic farming, which is crucial to health and food security in the Philippines.

Sen. Loren Legarda commended TCG for this endeavor.

She mentioned it in her speech at the Green Summit sponsored by World Bank's IFC, after watching the actual demo in the exhibit.

The event also gave CEF the opportunity to open to the public its one-day seminar on 'Best Green Practices in Commercial Kitchens' soon.

This aims to promote Green Chefmanship and Going Zero Waste in the hospitality industry.

For more information on CEF's seminars and activities, call Mel Adriano of CEF (4/F, CCA Bldg, 287 Katipunan Avenue), with nos. (02) 4261338, 9253969; e-mail: admin@cefmanila.com or follow them on Facebook.